

Additional Questions and Answers

RFQ 140G0226Q0038

**LABVIEW SOFTWARE BRAND NAME OR EQUAL
DEVELOPMENT/TRAINING SERVICES for the
USGS, Denver Argon Geochronology Lab
(DAGL), Denver, CO.**

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7. Question #7:

“Please confirm whether the requirement for experience supporting earth and atmospheric science laboratories is strictly mandatory, or if experience in other scientific laboratory environments (e.g., physics, chemistry, or biology labs) demonstrating equivalent expertise in instrument integration and scientific software development will be considered acceptable. If acceptable, please clarify how equivalency will be evaluated.”

USGS’s Response: Experience supporting earth and atmospheric science laboratories is essential to ensure the Contractor is familiar with the type of instrumentation and its applications. The U.S. Geological Survey’s Denver Argon Geochronology Lab (DAGL) involves highly specialized scientific instruments, unique data-acquisition workflows, rigorous environmental controls, and custom software ecosystems that are not reasonably comparable to other laboratory environments.

8. Question #8:

“Please confirm whether all development activities must be performed onsite at the Denver Federal Center, or if a hybrid model (remote development with periodic onsite integration/testing) is permissible. If hybrid is allowed, please specify the expected onsite frequency and any tasks that must be strictly performed onsite.”

USGS’s Response: The lead developer is expected to be onsite throughout the development of the product. The computer system connected to the instrumentation is not accessible remotely.

9. Question #9:

“Does the Government have any preferred or existing software architecture frameworks, design patterns, or reusable code bases (e.g., from other USGS labs) that the contractor is required or encouraged to leverage?”

USGS’s Response: The Contractor will be granted access to a comparable LabVIEW package from a similar laboratory for their use.

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10. Question #10:

“Will the contractor be provided access to existing LabVIEW-based systems from other USGS labs or legacy configurations (e.g., Mass Spec or Pychron) for reference, reuse, or integration?”

USGS’s Response: The Contractor will be granted access to an existing LabVIEW package from a comparable laboratory for potential reuse and adaptation. They will also receive access to the Pychron codebase.

11. Question #11:

“Can the Government provide additional details regarding communication protocols and interface documentation availability for required hardware components (e.g., Argus VI mass spectrometers, Photon Machines lasers, Agilent DAQs, ion pumps, and pressure gauges)?”

USGS’s Response: This information will be provided to the Contractor upon initiation of development.

12. Question #12:

“Will the contractor have continuous access to all required hardware systems during development, or will access be limited or scheduled?”

USGS’s Response: Access will be scheduled and limited to periods when laboratory scientists are available. The Contractor will not receive personal access to Government computer systems.

13. Question #13:

“Does the Government have a preferred data storage architecture (e.g., database type, file formats, schema standards), or is the contractor expected to propose a solution?”

USGS’s Response: Under Section E of the Performance Work Statement it states that “Data are accurately and reliably stored in appropriate file formats and/or database.”

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14. Question #14:

“To what extent is the contractor responsible for Certification & Accreditation (C&A), security documentation, and support for Authority to Operate (ATO) processes under applicable FISMA/NIST requirements?”

USGS’s Response: The section on C&A on page 15 is not applicable. The only applicable responses are: 8) Property Rights; 9) Independent Verification and Validation; and 13) Quality Control.

15. Question #15:

“Are there specific requirements for version control, GitLab repository structure, CI/CD pipelines, or release management practices, or is the contractor expected to define these?”

USGS’s Response: There are no specific requirements associated with these items.

16. Question #16:

“Can the Government clarify the expected scope and depth of training, including the number of personnel to be trained, target proficiency level, and preferred delivery format?”

USGS’s Response: Training will be required for two personnel. Upon completion, they should be fully capable of operating, maintaining, and updating the product. Training must be conducted in person at the laboratory.

17. Question #17:

“Who will be responsible for defining acceptance test procedures, performing validation testing, and providing final acceptance approval for each module and the integrated solution?”

USGS’s Response: Laboratory Staff will be responsible for developing acceptance test procedures, performing validation testing, and issuing final acceptance approval for each module and the integrated solution.

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18. Question #18:

“Are there defined performance requirements for system responsiveness, data acquisition rates, or concurrent instrument operation?”

USGS’s Response: No internal documents or communications identified to date define performance requirements for system responsiveness, data acquisition rates, or concurrent instrument operation.

19. Question #19:

“Beyond providing an Accessibility Conformance Report (ACR/VPAT), is the contractor expected to perform full Section 508 testing, remediation, and ongoing compliance support?”

USGS’s Response: The Contractor is not required to perform full Section 508 testing, remediation, or ongoing compliance support.

20. Question #20:

“Is there a requirement for a dedicated lead developer or key personnel to remain assigned throughout the period of performance? If so, please specify any minimum staffing or continuity requirements.”

USGS’s Response: Under Evaluation Factor B it states “A single lead developer must remain assigned throughout the project.”

21. Question #21:

“What are the Government’s expectations for transition and knowledge transfer at the end of the base period, including documentation, code handover, and transition support into option years or follow-on efforts?”

USGS’s Response: The PWS does not specify any documentation requirements. All code will be developed on the laboratory computer and will remain on that system upon project completion.